

Chapter 157-9

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It was still the same café where she had met with the Huayi representative last time. Gu Xingyue, whom she hadn't seen in a long time, had become quite thin. The baby fat on her face was completely gone, making her chin appear somewhat sharp. The gentle temperament she used to have was no longer there, replaced by—a sense of mystery.

That was the only word Liang Shi could use to describe it.

Because no other word was quite fitting.

Gu Xingyue was wearing a pea-green knitted dress. Her coat was haute couture from a very niche foreign designer brand, probably costing six figures. It was in gray tones, but it didn't look out of place.

She sat in the sunlight, yet there was no light in her eyes.

Liang Shi nodded in greeting and sat across from her. "Long time no see."

It was a very clichéd opening line.

Gu Xingyue smiled at her. "Long time no see."

All the qualities that belonged to "Qi Jiao" had completely dissipated from her. What remained was only Gu Xingyue.

Liang Shi said in a low voice: "Congratulations on your rebirth."

"Yes." Gu Xingyue said. "Thank you for helping me make up my mind."

Liang Shi asked if she had been in contact with Gu Zhaoyuan. Gu Xingyue slowly shook her head. "I've only seen him once."

It was at Gu Yingbo's funeral.

And because Gu Xingyue had been injured before, she had been staying at the hospital these past days.

She had very little contact with the outside world.

Liang Shi asked her: "You haven't seen anyone at all?"

Gu Xingyue nodded: "I've been contemplating life during those days."

"And what did you figure out?"

"Nothing." Gu Xingyue shrugged. "But I did finish writing a novel."

Liang Shi: "?"

Gu Xingyue smiled slightly. "I think I understand now why Qi Jiao liked to write in her diary."

"What?" Liang Shi asked.

Gu Xingyue: "Writing can calm a person down."

Liang Shi nodded: "That's pretty nice, finding something you like to do."

Because of Gu Xingyue's special identity, the Qi family's company ultimately still fell into her hands.

Because legally, she was still Qi Jiao, the person with legal inheritance rights.

That company with a nine-figure valuation fell to Gu Xingyue, but Gu Xingyue had no talent in this area. Qi Xiangui had acted as if he never thought he would die, so he had never taught Gu Xingyue any skills for managing a company.

Gu Xingyue sold the company. Half of the assets were donated to the nation, one-third to charitable organizations, and another third to orphanages. She kept only the small remainder for herself.

It had also been two days since Yang Jiani's court hearing.

She hadn't been paying attention to these matters these days. Probably because the evidence was too conclusive, Liang Shi hadn't been summoned as a witness.

She also heard about it from Gu Xingyue.

The most shocking news was: Yang Jiani had committed suicide.

The procuratorate had sentenced Yang Jiani to life imprisonment. On the way from the procuratorate to the prison, Yang Jiani had somehow obtained a piece of string and strangled herself.

Unexpected.

But within reason.

Someone like Yang Jiani probably felt that life was hopeless and then atoned for her sins in this way.

Liang Shi was surprised for quite a while when she heard this.

Gu Xingyue shook her head and said: "I wanted to tell you that day, but your phone couldn't get through."

"I had something going on and turned off my phone for a couple of days." Liang Shi said.

"Anyway, we're both liberated now." As Gu Xingyue spoke, she took out a USB drive from her bag and handed it over. "This thing—you probably won't want to see it, but I'll give it to you anyway."

Liang Shi frowned: "What is this?"

Gu Xingyue paused briefly: "Some videos of you and Qi Jiao from when you were children."

"You must be mentally prepared before watching." Gu Xingyue said. "But I suggest you don't watch it. Just forget about those things."

Liang Shi: "...Alright."

When Liang Shi picked up the USB drive, she felt as if it was heavy.

She didn't know why she had this feeling.

Liang Shi looked at her and suddenly spoke up in the silence: "Have you ever thought about who your biological parents are?"

Gu Xingyue was startled: "Why do you ask?"

Liang Shi thought about it and still said: "I... probably know who your biological mother is."

Her speech paused, and because of nervousness, she stumbled over her breathing several times in the wrong places.

Gu Xingyue fell silent again.

Liang Shi didn't know whether she should continue, but after a long while, Gu Xingyue asked: "Is she still alive?"

Liang Shi immediately nodded: "And she's been looking for you all along."

"How do you know?" Gu Xingyue asked.

Liang Shi immediately said: "You know your blood type is very rare, right? That day when you lost too much blood, the only blood bag in the blood bank that matched your blood type had a rejection reaction when they were transfusing it to you. It happened to be my friend's teacher. Because she was suspicious, she went and did a DNA test, and then..."

This was indeed a beautiful accident.

But Liang Shi felt that this kind of accident was quite nice.

After hearing this, Gu Xingyue felt like it was surreal and even began to doubt the authenticity of the matter: "You're not lying to me?"

Liang Shi: "...Why would I lie to you?"

"That report is with my friend right now." Liang Shi said. "And your mother is a literature professor at a university. Though we're not clear about her marital status. According to my friend, she often goes to see doctors alone."

Gu Xingyue hesitated.

Liang Shi added more fuel to the fire: "Do you want to go see your biological mother? Even if you don't acknowledge each other, you could at least meet."

Gu Xingyue: "..."

"After all, you're all alone now." Liang Shi said. "It's always good to have family around."

Gu Xingyue wavered. After a moment, she asked: "What's her name?"

"Feng Xian." Liang Shi said.